

SPECIAL ISSUE

60 GREATEST INDIANS

From those who **stood up** to the Empire to those
who **built empires** of the mind, those who were
in the **vanguard of** the freedom struggle to those who
managed the freedom, **a list** of men and women who
have **made India** a place of perpetual **astonishment**

■ By S. Prasannarajan

The story of a nation is the biography of its people. India is a confluence of a billion life stories, an expansive narrative whose structural variations are only matched by its thematic abundance. Get into it and be swayed by the whirl of passions, paradoxes and ironies. So it is not surprising that, in the panegyrics of geopolitics and globalism, India is the exclamation mark of the East. Its democracy is the only reassuring drama in a region where the show is still about less evolved civil societies. Its marketplace has already shed all those socialist inhibitions and become the playground of the so-called wealth multipliers. And in the digital planet, Indian is an adjective to be reckoned with. When